



QUESTION
OF THE
MONTH



Your Questions, Our Answers

All your computing niggles and nags
are dealt with here!

Poof!

Q My computer suddenly shuts down after a few minutes of activity. My service engineer checked everything including the heatsink and fans, but found nothing wrong. He replaced a few capacitors on the motherboard, but the problem persists.

J Ramesh

A Since you've already gotten everything checked, our guess is that your power supply is at fault—either it is not able to deliver enough power to your PC, or there is some other problem with it. Get it examined and possibly replaced. You could go through our December issue for an idea about what kind of PSU you need.

Playing With Partitions

Q I am aware that there is a partition resizing utility in Vista, and I want to try it out, but I'm a little afraid because of the risks involved. Please tell me what I need to know.

Ankit Pathak

A The Disk Management Utility in Vista is an upgrade over that in XP; it can resize disk volumes (partitions). Before getting into it, do back up all your data, because although it can resize partitions keeping the data intact, there is always the risk of data loss in the case of a sudden interruption (such as a power failure).

Open the Control Panel and type Partition in the search box. Click on Administrative Tools: Create and format hard disk partitions. To shrink a volume, right-click on the partition to be shrunk (in Disk Management) and select Shrink Volume. You will be able to see the current size, space available to shrink, a dialog box to enter the amount to shrink by, and the volume size after shrinking. Enter the amount to shrink (in MB) and click Shrink. Similarly, to extend a volume

(increase the size), right-click on the partition and select Extend Volume; the Extend Volume Wizard will start. Here, you can specify the amount that you want to increase the partition by. Click Next, then on Finish to start the process.

It's Just The Drivers

Q I'm having a problem with the game *Gangland*. I've played the demo earlier, but now the full version I bought gives this error:

```
==== Console::Initialize() =====
Compiled Sep 27 2005 10:58:36
(release build)
Renderer rejected: RendererD3D.DLL
Renderer found: RendererOGL v. 1.3
(release build)
RenderOGL::GLInitialize(): Using
Microsoft Corporation GDI Generic
RenderOGL::GLInitialize(): OpenGL
version 1.1.0
RenderOGL::GLInitialize(): Card
doesn't support
GL_EXT_texture_compression_s3tc
Error creating renderer instance
What should I do? I'm using an ASUS V9400
Magic graphics card.
```

Vijesh Vijayan

A Your graphics card is based on the NVIDIA GeForce4 MX 4000 chipset. The error message indicates that your OpenGL renderer does not support S3TC (S3 Texture Compression). The error message also indicates that the game is trying to use the graphics renderer from Microsoft and not from NVIDIA, so your OpenGL file could be corrupt, or there could be a problem with your graphics drivers. Since your graphics card supports S3TC, we suggest you install the latest reference drivers for your card from www.nvidia.com. Your problem should be solved now.

Back From The Future

Q I upgraded from XP to Vista and I want to get back to XP. How can I do it without losing any of my program settings?

Manu Shastry

A Currently, it is not possible to downgrade from Vista to XP and retain all program settings. You would have to do a clean format of the partition and install XP. We'd advise our readers to dual-boot between Vista and XP (instead of upgrading) if they just want to get a taste of the new OS. Assuming Vista is installed on a partition different from where XP is installed, do the following to uninstall it. Boot into XP. Insert your Vista DVD into the drive or load the image in DVD emulation software. Run `X:\boot\bootsect.exe /nt52 ALL /force` where X is your Vista DVD drive letter. Restart the computer and you will find that the old XP boot menu has returned. Format the partition where you'd installed Vista, and remove Boot.BAK and Bootsect.BAK. That's it!

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

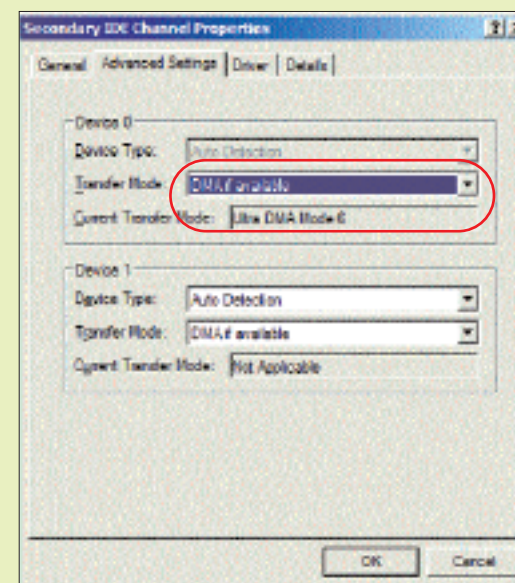
Mode Mess

Q My Sony DRU-820A DVD-Writer takes almost an hour to copy a DVD. What could be the problem?

Bhuvnesh Agrawal

A The data transfer mode of the DVD-Writer is probably set to PIO, which is a lower-speed mode than the DMA mode it should run at. To check this, open the Device Manager by running `devmgmt.msc`, expand IDE/ATAPI controllers, double-click Primary IDE Channel, and click on Advanced Settings. Set the Transfer Mode to "DMA if available", click OK, and restart the computer. If that doesn't help, you might need to delete that channel and restart the computer to re-detect the hardware. You might also need to repeat this with the Secondary IDE Channel if your drive is not listed. If nothing happens after restarting, you should uninstall the IDE channel from the device manager and restart the computer so it can re-detect everything on that channel. Your drive will now work in DMA mode and its transfer speed will improve.

If it doesn't, try changing the IDE cable. You might need to replace the drive if none of the above helps.



Make
sure the
IDE
Channel is
set to
"DMA if
available"

Machine Language

Q Whenever I restart my Windows XP computer, I get this error message: "Stop 0xC000021A".

Bhavesh Shah

A This happens if the Wbemprox.dll library is prematurely unloaded. You need to download and install the hotfix from <http://go.microsoft.com/?linkid=6294451> (<http://tinyurl.com/34jrgl>). Restart your computer and you should find it's OK.

Unpacking The Service!

Q I recently installed SP1 on Windows XP and then used System Restore to revert Windows to the previous state. I am now not able to create a network connection.

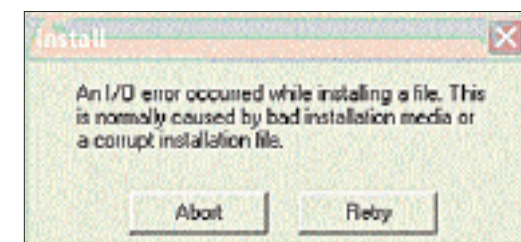
Ram Kapadia

A If you reinstall SP1, the problem will be solved, but if for some reason you don't want to install SP1, there is a workaround. Open the Registry Editor and go to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\RasMan`. Select File > Export, type EXPKEY in the File Name box, and click Save. Double-click on the ObjectName String Value in the RasMan key, type LocalSystem in the Value Data box, and click OK. Go to `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\RasMan\PPP\EAP\25` and delete the key. (Click Yes to confirm.) Do the same with `HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\RasMan\PPP\EAP\26`. Restart your computer. You should now be able to create a network connection.

Beep No More!

Q I want to turn off system beeps, but I don't want this to affect any other audio settings on my computer.

S Gopal



Errors like these occur when installer files are corrupt

A To disable system beeps, open the Registry Editor and go to `HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Sound`. Modify or create the String Value Beeps in the right pane and set its value to 0. Restart for the setting to take effect.

So It's A Coaster...

Q Whenever I try to install ASHAMPOO WIN OPTIMIZER 2007 from the *Digit* CD, it shows the following error message: "An I/O error occurred while installing a file." When I abort it, a message says "corrupt installation file." How do I install it?

Sunney

A Like the error message says, this happens when the installer file is corrupt or damaged, and that often happens often when the media itself is damaged.

Please e-mail help@jasubhai.com for a replacement.

Slo-Mo

Q I have an Athlon XP 3000+, an ASUS V82-m motherboard, and 512 MB of RAM. My problem is that *Quake 3* runs very slowly.

Shakti Dash

A Check whether the latest ForceWare drivers are installed; they are available at www.nvidia.com.

Also, try playing the game at lower resolutions and turn down the effects.